

Expanded Videography Plan – Gambia Charity (Water, Food, School)

Introduction

This expanded videography plan provides detailed guidance for capturing high-quality footage for the Water, Food, and School charity project in The Gambia.

The aim is to show real struggles, highlight the community's needs, and produce professional, emotional, and impactful videos that can be shared online with potential donors, partners, and supporters.

General Approach

The videos should not feel rushed. They should allow viewers to experience life in the community, understand challenges, and see the urgency of support.

The videographer is encouraged to be creative while following these instructions, using both planned shots and spontaneous opportunities that present themselves on the ground.

****Key Reminders:****

- Always obtain permission before filming inside houses or when interviewing people.
- Focus on authenticity: natural sounds, everyday activities, and community interaction are powerful storytelling tools.
- Combine wide establishing shots, medium interaction shots, and close-up detail shots to create visual variety.
- Pay attention to lighting and sound; natural daylight is best, and minimize background noise when possible.

Timeline & Structure

- Filming each house should take ****30–40 minutes**** of focused material.
- Visiting 3 houses will produce roughly 2 hours of raw footage.
- Additional shots of the village, school, and surrounding areas will add another 2–3 hours.
- Total recording day: 5–6 hours (before Maghrib).

****Video Length Goals:****

- Main video (per topic: Water, Food, School): 10–15 minutes each after editing.
- Main house raw footage: ~40 minutes.
- Extra footage: at least 1 hour for editing flexibility.

Water Section (Detailed)

1. Start with a ****360° wide shot of the house and surroundings**** (after permission).
2. Walk into the house slowly, capturing daily water-related struggles.
3. Show all water storage: buckets, jerry cans, utensils, kitchen area.
4. Record an interview: ask the family to explain where they get water, how far it is, how heavy it feels, how many trips are made daily, and how safe the water is.
5. Show the water source itself (walk the distance, record the journey).
6. Record activities involving water: washing clothes, cooking, children fetching water.
7. Highlight the difficulties: shortage, cost of water, lack of hygiene or sanitation.
8. Close with a wide shot of the family, showing their daily life while discussing needs.

Food Section (Detailed)

1. Begin with a shot of the kitchen and eating area.
2. Show utensils, food supplies, and empty shelves if shortages exist.
3. Record interviews: ask about daily meals, what food is available, and what is often missing.
4. Show children eating (with permission), or struggling with lack of food.
5. Capture the cooking process, even if very simple.
6. Emphasize struggles: families without proper stoves, shortage of ingredients, reliance on single meals per day.
7. Show the mother or caretaker preparing food, to make it personal and relatable.
8. End with footage of the family eating together or explaining how they cope.

School Section (Detailed)

1. Begin by recording the ****journey to school****: children walking the distance (show environment, roads, obstacles).
2. Capture the outside of the school (wide shot), then walk into the classroom.
3. Show inside the classrooms: desks, blackboards, materials (or lack of them).
4. Film students during regular lessons (capture natural activity).
5. Interview teachers or students about challenges (lack of books, chairs, overcrowding).
6. Record examples of missing resources: broken desks, torn books, shared writing materials.
7. Highlight the resilience of students and teachers despite these challenges.
8. End with wide shots of the schoolyard, showing the number of students and general conditions.

Village Walkthrough (Detailed)

1. Start with a wide 360° establishing shot of the entire village.
2. Slowly walk through streets, capturing daily activities (markets, children playing, animals, cooking outside).
3. Show the environment: unpaved roads, damaged houses, lack of infrastructure.
4. Highlight the water system (if any exists) and its condition.
5. Interview community members about overall struggles (water, food, education).
6. Capture contrasts: children happy while playing despite poverty; empty water containers; families gathering outside.
7. End with a strong wide shot of the village as the sun lowers (before Maghrib).

Collaboration & Feedback

- Videographer should review footage with the project lead (Libra) after recording sessions.
- Mistakes or missed shots can be corrected in later visits.
- Encourage the videographer to propose creative angles and ideas.
- Combine structured filming with flexibility to capture unique and spontaneous moments.

Final Output

- Deliverables:
 - 3 main videos (Water, Food, School).
 - Additional raw footage for editing.
- Duration:
 - Each final video: 10–15 minutes polished.
 - Raw footage total: 5–6 hours across one filming day.
- Purpose:
 - Videos will be published on the charity's website and social platforms to raise awareness and attract donors/partners.